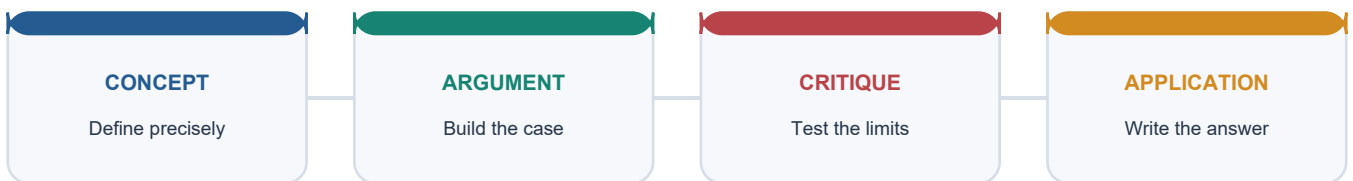


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Liberty, Equality and Property - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Liberty, Equality and Property - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 18 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Answer:?**

- A. Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.
- B. Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.
- C. Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.
- D. Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: the source records this exact proposition - liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Misplaced: social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely social control rather than abolition of personal use.
- B. Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power.
- C. Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.
- D. MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B This is the recorded association: the source records this exact proposition - civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power.
- **C:** C Misplaced: locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: macCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Civil liberty protects personal action by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Civil liberty protects personal action.

MCQ 3

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.
- B. Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.
- C. Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.
- D. Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Misplaced: liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Negative liberty asks whether another person or by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Negative liberty asks whether another person or.

MCQ 4

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.
- B. Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.
- C. MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified.
- D. Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: macCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such.

MCQ 5

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self.
- B. Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power.
- C. Domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that capacity is not exercised.
- D. A person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can reduce domination.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: the source records this exact proposition - berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Mismatched: domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **D:** D Not this pair: a person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can be recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns.

MCQ 6

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power.
- B. Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit.
- C. Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.
- D. Formal equality removes explicit exclusion, while substantive equality tests usable access, background conditions and actual opportunity.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Exact pair: the source records this exact proposition - mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit.
- **C:** C Not this pair: nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: formal equality removes explicit exclusion, while substantive equality tests usable access, background is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits.

MCQ 7

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.
- B. Rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by convention.
- C. Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.
- D. Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Not this pair: rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

- **C:** C Source-exact: the source records this exact proposition - roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the.

MCQ 8

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Taylor argues that an open opportunity is insufficient where internalised or social obstacles prevent meaningful exercise, while Berlin warns against paternalist correction.
- B. Affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse discrimination is an objection, not a neutral label.
- C. Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely social control rather than abolition of personal use.
- D. Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Taylor argues that an open opportunity is insufficient where internalised or social obstacles prevent is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Source disagrees: Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely is recorded elsewhere in the topic, so it is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: the source records this exact proposition - Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic; here the tested item is Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities
- B. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy
- C. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- D. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.

- **B:** B Source disagrees: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities
- B. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- C. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy
- D. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Positive liberty.

MCQ 11

Which pair keeps the proposition with the name or concept the source attaches it to?

- A. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- B. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy
- C. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities
- D. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Liberty.

MCQ 12

Which pairing is exact, rather than borrowed from an adjacent part of the same topic?

- A. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities
- B. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance
- C. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- D. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.
- **B:** B Not this pair: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; here the tested item is Negative liberty.

MCQ 13

One pairing below is faithful to the source. Which one?

- A. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities
- B. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy
- C. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- D. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially wher.

MCQ 14

Which label-proposition pair would not be corrected by the source text?

- A. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities
- B. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- C. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy
- D. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not

correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with.

MCQ 15

Which of the following associations is reproduced exactly as recorded?

- A. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities
- B. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- C. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy
- D. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 2: Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstac.

MCQ 16

Which pair matches its proposition without drifting to a related concept?

- A. Positive liberty: two senses - Equality is a claim of right and equal moral worth, not a statement that all persons are factually identical in talent, strength or circumstance
- B. Negative liberty - Freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy
- C. Positive liberty - Do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism
- D. Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Positive liberty: two senses is recorded with do not conflate Berlin's sense of self-mastery with positive liberalism's enabling-conditions sense. Gauba expressly says Berlin's positive liberty does not correspond to welfare/positive liberalism.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Negative liberty is recorded with freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the state abstains from imposing unreasonable restraints on speech, worship, movement and similar activities.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Positive liberty is recorded with freedom secured by removing socially created obstacles such as poverty, insecurity, unemployment or lack of education where these are alterable by public policy.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Liberty is recorded with liberty is commonly described as absence of restraint, but Gauba insists that in society it means absence of unreasonable restraint and protection of conditions in which human capacities can develop.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially where the; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism; tested item 3: Liberty - Freedom from interference in chosen actions, especially wher.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely social control rather than abolition of personal use.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2

- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 2 only.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Property can support personal independence but concentrated productive ownership can control others' labour and life-chances.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 1 only does not validate the second pairing; here the tested item is 1 only.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.

- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with 2 only does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: 2 only.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Both 1 and 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Both 1 and 2.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Answer:** is associated with: Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.
2. **Answer:** is associated with: Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Neither 1 nor 2 does not validate the second pairing; tested item 2: Neither 1 nor 2.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Positive liberty means the state may command whatever it likes.?**

- A. Positive liberty means removing socially alterable obstacles to self-development; it does not justify unlimited authority (Gaubu, PDF pp.379-381).
- B. Gauba stresses that legal access and political rights may remain ineffective amid poverty, hierarchy and unequal bargaining power (Gaubu, PDF pp.401-406).
- C. Gauba explicitly rejects literal equalization and allows differential treatment on grounds of need and socially useful excellence (Gaubu, PDF pp.395-398, 410).
- D. It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Positive liberty means removing socially alterable obstacles to self-development; it does not justify unlimited authority (Gaubu, PDF pp.379-381).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Formal equality before law automatically yields justice.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Equality means identical treatment or identical shares for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Substantive equality means identical outcomes.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Positive liberty means the state may command, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Berlin, Green, Hayek and Nozick use "positive liberty" in the same way.?**

- A. Gauba stresses that legal access.
- B. Berlin's
- C. Positive liberty means removing.
- D. Gauba explicitly rejects literal.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Formal equality before law automatically yields justice.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Berlin's.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Positive liberty means the state may command whatever it likes.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Equality means identical treatment or identical shares for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Berlin, Green, Hayek and Nozick use "positive, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Liberty and equality are natural enemies.**?

- A. Reverse discrimination is an objection; compensatory, anti-subordination, representational and fair-opportunity justifications must be assessed on their own terms.
- B. It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.
- C. Gauba treats them as complementary when liberty is understood as equal liberty and equality as reasonable, not literal, equalization (Gauba, PDF pp.392-393).
- D. The chapters distinguish security-giving personal holdings from productive assets that can become instruments of power over others (Gauba, PDF pp.414, 419-431).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Affirmative action is neutrally described as reverse discrimination.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Substantive equality means identical outcomes.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba treats them as complementary when liberty is understood as equal liberty and equality as reasonable, not literal, equalization (Gauba, PDF pp.392-393, 407-410).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Property is one undifferentiated right.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Liberty and equality are natural enemies, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Equality means identical treatment or identical shares for all.**?

- A. Reverse discrimination is an objection; compensatory, anti-subordination, representational and fair-opportunity justifications must be assessed on their own terms.
- B. It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.
- C. The chapters distinguish security-giving personal holdings from productive assets that can become instruments of power over others (Gauba, PDF pp.414, 419-431).
- D. Gauba explicitly rejects literal equalization and allows differential treatment on grounds of need and socially useful excellence (Gauba, PDF pp.395-398, 410).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Affirmative action is neutrally described as reverse discrimination.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Substantive equality means identical outcomes.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Property is one undifferentiated right.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly rejects literal equalization and allows differential treatment on grounds of need and socially useful excellence (Gauba, PDF pp.395-398, 410).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Equality means identical treatment or identical, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Formal equality before law automatically yields justice.?**

- A. Gauba stresses that legal access and political rights may remain ineffective amid poverty, hierarchy and unequal bargaining power (Gauba, PDF pp.401-406).
- B. Gauba explicitly rejects literal equalization and allows differential treatment on grounds of need and socially useful excellence (Gauba, PDF pp.395-398, 410).
- C. It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.
- D. The chapters distinguish security-giving personal holdings from productive assets that can become instruments of power over others (Gauba, PDF pp.414, 419-431).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba stresses that legal access and political rights may remain ineffective amid poverty, hierarchy and unequal bargaining power (Gauba, PDF pp.401-406).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Equality means identical treatment or identical shares for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Substantive equality means identical outcomes.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Property is one undifferentiated right.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Formal equality before law automatically yields, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Substantive equality means identical outcomes.?**

- A. The chapters distinguish security-giving personal holdings from productive assets that can become instruments of power over others (Gauba, PDF pp.414, 419-431).
- B. It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.
- C. Gauba explicitly rejects literal equalization and allows differential treatment on grounds of need and socially useful excellence (Gauba, PDF pp.395-398, 410).
- D. Reverse discrimination is an objection; compensatory, anti-subordination, representational and fair-opportunity justifications must be assessed on their own terms.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Property is one undifferentiated right.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Equality means identical treatment or identical shares for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Affirmative action is neutrally described as reverse discrimination.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Substantive equality means identical outcomes, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Affirmative action is neutrally described as reverse discrimination.**?

- A. It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.
- B. Gauba treats them as complementary when liberty is understood as equal liberty and equality as reasonable, not literal, equalization (Gauba, PDF pp.392-393, 407-410).
- C. Reverse discrimination is an objection; compensatory, anti-subordination, representational and fair-opportunity justifications must be assessed on their own.
- D. The chapters distinguish security-giving personal holdings from productive assets that can become instruments of power over others (Gauba, PDF pp.414, 419-431).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Substantive equality means identical outcomes.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Liberty and equality are natural enemies.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Reverse discrimination is an objection; compensatory, anti-subordination, representational and fair-opportunity justifications must be assessed on their own terms.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Property is one undifferentiated right.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Affirmative action is neutrally described as reverse, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Property is one undifferentiated right.**?

- A. Reverse discrimination is an objection; compensatory, anti-subordination, representational and fair-opportunity justifications must be assessed on their own terms.
- B. It may require fair opportunity, capability thresholds, a social minimum or limits on avoidable deprivation without erasing every difference produced by choice.
- C. Gauba explicitly rejects literal equalization and allows differential treatment on grounds of need and socially useful excellence (Gauba, PDF pp.395-398, 410).
- D. The chapters distinguish security-giving personal holdings from productive assets that can become instruments of power over others (Gauba, PDF pp.414, 419-431).

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Affirmative action is neutrally described as reverse discrimination.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Substantive equality means identical outcomes.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Equality means identical treatment or identical shares for all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: The chapters distinguish security-giving personal holdings from productive assets that can become instruments of power over others (Gauba, PDF pp.414, 419-431).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Property is one undifferentiated right, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Liberty, Equality and Property** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain why Mill's distinction between self-regarding and other-regarding conduct does not make every socially consequential act coercible. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive explain requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of why Mill's distinction between self-regarding and other-regarding conduct does not make every socially consequential act coercible in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Mill's, Core and Expression, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that it does not erase the presumption for liberty.

Model answer (150 words):

Introduction: Mill's harm principle creates a presumption of liberty for competent adults: coercion against their will is justified presumptively to prevent harm to others, not merely because conduct is disliked, offensive or imprudent. Core analysis: The self-regarding and other-regarding distinction identifies the primary direction of an act's effects, but social consequence is broader than harm. Expression, consumption and unconventional living may influence others, alter norms or impose discomfort without violating a protected interest. If every indirect effect counted as harm, the principle would license majority morality and destroy the experimental individuality Mill values. Regulation therefore requires a specified victim, sufficiently serious setback, causal connection and proportionate response. That difficulty shifts the burden to justification; it does not erase the presumption for liberty. Conclusion: Mill's principle is therefore a strong presumption for individuality under a harm-based burden of proof, not a mechanical rule that converts every social effect into legitimate coercion.

Why this earns marks: it obeys explain instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Mill's, Core and Expression), converts that evidence into analysis of why Mill's distinction between self-regarding and other-regarding conduct does not make every socially consequential act coercible, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that it does not erase the presumption for liberty. At 150 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish formal equality, substantive equality, equality of opportunity and equality of outcome. Can differential treatment serve equality? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of formal equality, substantive equality, equality of opportunity and equality of outcome. Can differential treatment serve equality in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Equality, Formal and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Differential treatment serves equality only when it removes a specified barrier to equal standing or fair opportunity, remains proportionate and reviewable, and does not become an unexamined substitute for structural reform.

Model answer (144 words):

Introduction: Equality contains several standards that answer different questions. Formal equality removes explicit legal privilege, while substantive equality asks whether equal status can actually be used under unequal social conditions. Core analysis: Equality of opportunity concerns genuinely fair access to offices and advantages, not merely an open rulebook. Equality of outcome examines whether final distributions leave avoidable deprivation or domination intact; it need not demand identical shares and may instead defend thresholds or a social minimum. Differential treatment can serve equality where identical rules reproduce a demonstrated disadvantage. A legitimate measure must identify the barrier, connect the classification to its removal, protect individual standing and remain proportionate, contestable and open to revision. Conclusion: Differential treatment serves equality only when it removes a specified barrier to equal standing or fair opportunity, remains proportionate and reviewable, and does not become an unexamined substitute for structural reform.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Equality, Formal and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of formal equality, substantive equality, equality of opportunity and equality of outcome. Can differential treatment serve equality, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Differential treatment serves equality only when it removes a specified barrier to equal standing or fair opportunity, remains proportionate and reviewable, and does not become an unexamined substitute for structural reform. At 144 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Compare Berlin's two concepts, Green's positive freedom and republican non-domination. Does MacCallum dissolve their differences? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of Berlin's two concepts, Green's positive freedom and republican non-domination. Does MacCallum dissolve their differences in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Berlin, Green and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: MacCallum reveals a shared grammatical structure, but Berlin, Green and republicanism remain substantively distinct because they identify different constraints, purposes and institutional dangers.

Model answer (150 words):

Introduction: Berlin distinguishes negative liberty as non-interference from positive liberty as self-mastery, while warning that a ruler may coercively claim to embody a person's higher self. Green uses a different positive language: freedom requires social conditions for moral development and meaningful action. Core analysis: Republican non-domination shifts the question from actual interference or capacity to the status of dependence under arbitrary power. The benevolent-master case shows why a person may face little current interference yet remain unfree through the master's standing capacity and impunity. MacCallum's formula - X is free from Y to do or become Z - places all freedom claims in one triadic grammar and exposes false verbal dichotomies. Berlin, Green and republicanism retain different diagnoses and different risks: neglect of capacity, paternalism and institutional overbreadth. Conclusion: MacCallum reveals a shared grammatical structure, but Berlin, Green and republicanism remain substantively distinct because they identify different constraints, purposes and institutional dangers.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Berlin, Green and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of Berlin's two concepts, Green's positive freedom and republican non-domination. Does MacCallum dissolve their differences, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: MacCallum reveals a shared grammatical structure, but Berlin, Green and republicanism remain substantively distinct because they identify different constraints, purposes and institutional dangers. At 150 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Locke, Hegel and Marx on the moral significance of property. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of Locke, Hegel and Marx on the moral significance of property in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Locke, Hegel and Marx, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Property is defensible neither as an absolute natural title nor as an undifferentiated evil: its justification depends on acquisition, personhood, social function and whether ownership enables autonomy or domination.

Model answer (183 words):

Introduction: Locke, Hegel and Marx treat property as morally significant through labour, personhood and social production respectively. Their disagreement concerns both the source and the limits of ownership. Core analysis: Locke grounds initial appropriation in labour under enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation, while survival of the first proviso remains contested. Hegel treats an external property sphere as the first embodiment of free will within Abstract Right, explaining why secure control matters for personality without proving an unlimited title to accumulation. Marx shifts from individual title to productive relations: personal use is not the main target, whereas private control of the means of production separates workers from product, activity and social power. Property then becomes alienation and class domination. Critical evaluation: Labour can justify an initial claim, personhood a protected sphere, and social production a structural critique. No one argument by itself validates every inherited, concentrated or productive holding. Conclusion: Property is defensible neither as an absolute natural title nor as an undifferentiated evil: its justification depends on acquisition, personhood, social function and whether ownership enables autonomy or domination.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Locke, Hegel and Marx), converts that evidence into analysis of Locke, Hegel and Marx on the moral significance of property, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Property is defensible neither as an absolute natural title nor as an undifferentiated evil: its justification depends on acquisition, personhood, social function and whether ownership enables autonomy or domination. At 183 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: The apparent conflict between liberty and equality is mediated by the distribution of property and social power. Evaluate through Rawls, Dworkin and Nozick. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of apparent conflict between liberty and equality is mediated by the distribution of property and social power. Evaluate through Rawls, Dworkin and Nozick in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Liberty, Once and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that critical evaluation: The theories cannot be fused.

Model answer (247 words):

Introduction: Liberty and equality appear opposed when property is treated as a pre-political domain immune from scrutiny. Once ownership is recognised as a distribution of resources and power, the dispute becomes one about background institutions, responsibility and history. Core analysis: Rawls gives equal basic liberties lexical priority but requires fair equality of opportunity and permits inequality only where it benefits the least advantaged. Dworkin's equality of resources uses hypothetical auction and insurance to neutralise brute luck while retaining responsibility for option luck. Nozick rejects patterned end-state rules and asks whether holdings arose through just acquisition and transfer under a modified Lockean proviso, with rectification for injustice. These standards expose different defects: structurally unfair starting points, unequal resource endowments and coercive or unjust historical title. The NAKSHA inquiry anchor illustrates why documented title, accessible procedure and contestability are distinct from redistribution. Further development: The comparison also changes the unit of evaluation. Rawls examines the basic structure, Dworkin the resource position of responsible agents, and Nozick the historical chain of holdings. A conclusion must therefore state whether institutions, endowments or transactions are being judged before calling an inequality unjust. Critical evaluation: The theories cannot be fused. A defensible judgment protects basic agency and title while testing whether property institutions reproduce avoidable dependence and whether rectification is sufficiently specified.

Conclusion: The liberty-equality conflict is best treated as a dispute over fair background institutions, resources and historical entitlement, with property justified only where its distribution survives all three forms of scrutiny.

Why this earns marks: it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Liberty, Once and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of apparent conflict between liberty and equality is mediated by the distribution of property and social power. Evaluate through Rawls, Dworkin and Nozick, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that critical evaluation: The theories cannot be fused. At 247 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Can affirmative action and redistribution enhance equal liberty without becoming paternalistic or arbitrary? Discuss using Mill, Berlin, Green, Rawls and Nozick. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive can requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of affirmative action and redistribution enhance equal liberty without becoming paternalistic or arbitrary? Discuss using Mill, Berlin, Green, Rawls and Nozick in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Affirmative, Core and Mill's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that critical evaluation: Correction becomes arbitrary when classifications lack evidence, remedies are disproportionate or affected people cannot contest them.

Model answer (236 words):

Introduction: Affirmative action and redistribution can enlarge liberty where deprivation and inherited exclusion make formally equal choice unusable. Their legitimacy nevertheless depends on preserving agency and constraining public discretion. Core analysis: Mill's harm principle resists coercion based merely on a person's own good, but his broader egalitarian and social reforms show that liberty need not mean laissez-faire. Green treats education, security and material capability as conditions of effective freedom. Rawls protects equal basic liberties while requiring fair opportunity and benefit to the least advantaged. Berlin supplies the warning: officials must not claim authority to impose citizens' true purposes. Nozick adds historical-title and rectification tests and rejects patterned seizure of just holdings. Affirmative action should therefore be justified through specified compensatory, anti-subordination, representational or opportunity mechanisms rather than the label of benevolent policy. Further development: Republican non-domination adds a further institutional test: a corrective measure should reduce arbitrary dependence rather than replace private domination with unreviewable official discretion. Effective notice, reason-giving, accessible appeal and periodic evaluation connect Green's enabling purpose to Berlin's and Nozick's limits on coercive power. Critical evaluation: Correction becomes arbitrary when classifications lack evidence, remedies are disproportionate or affected people cannot contest them. It enhances equal liberty when rules are transparent, reviewable, time-sensitive and directed at demonstrable barriers. Conclusion: Group-sensitive correction can enlarge equal liberty when it removes demonstrable barriers under transparent, proportionate and contestable rules, while preserving agency, basic liberties and historical-title scrutiny.

Why this earns marks: it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Affirmative, Core and Mill's), converts that evidence into analysis of affirmative action and redistribution enhance equal liberty without becoming paternalistic or arbitrary? Discuss using Mill, Berlin, Green, Rawls and Nozick, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that critical evaluation: Correction becomes arbitrary when classifications lack evidence, remedies are disproportionate or affected people cannot contest them. At 236 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
